

Work Experience

2026



Kew High School
2026

What is Work Experience?

Work experience is a short-term placement of secondary school students (usually Year 10) with employers to provide insights into different industries and workplaces.

Work experience is a compulsory part of the Pathways program for all Year 10 students. Students are required to undertake a one-week block of work experience in the last week of Term 2. Students are eligible to undertake work experience if they are over 15 years of age. Work experience provides students with a valuable opportunity to:

- develop employability skills (communication, teamwork, problem solving, planning and organisation, initiative)
- explore possible career options
- understand employer/workplace expectations
- increase their self-understanding, independence and self-confidence.

While undertaking work experience, students will observe different aspects of work within their chosen industry and may assist with tasks allocated by their supervisor. Students should not undertake activities that require extensive training or expertise.

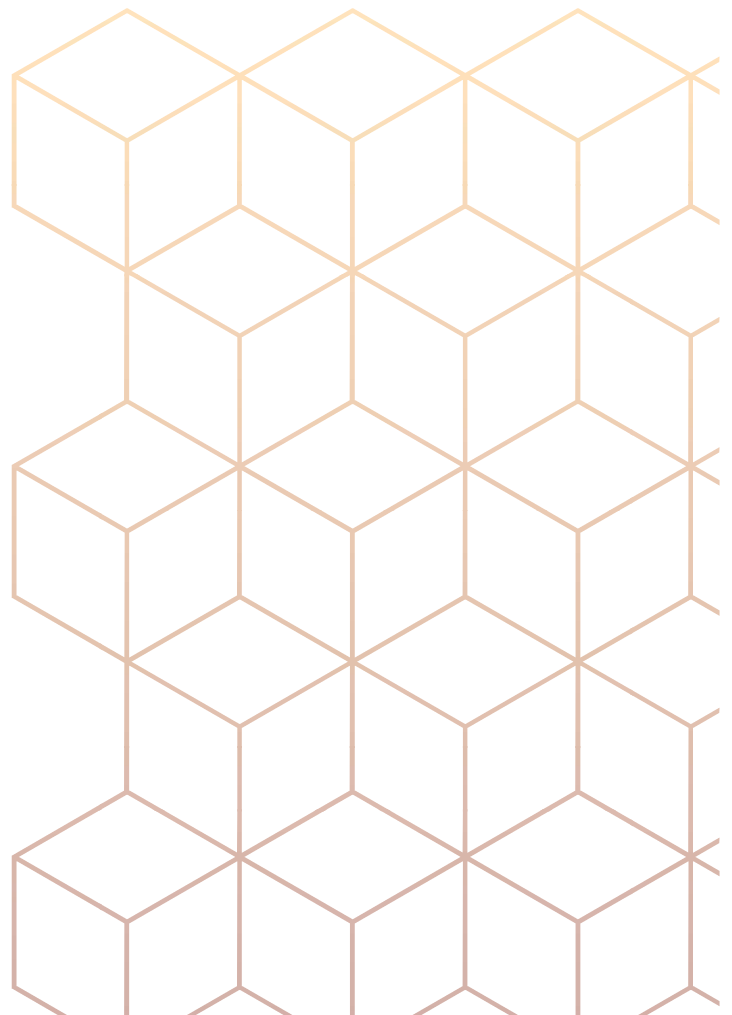
Work experience is designed to be an observation program where the student is exposed to a future career direction or workplace of interest.

Placements with parents are not recommended, as students will benefit more from meeting challenges in new environments.

When is Work Experience ?

The work experience block week that has been scheduled for all Year 10 students to attend their work experience placement is Monday 22nd June to Friday 26th June.

Some students may not be able to get a placement in their desired field during the scheduled work experience week. Dates and times may be negotiated, but school approval must be given prior to the placement.



Important steps in the work experience process

Step 1: Find an employer/workplace

Work experience must be done with an employer. It is preferred that students do not work in the family business and that they find a meaningful placement within an industry they are interested in.

Students should plan now and find an employer as soon as possible.

Please note:

- Students cannot work interstate.
- Students cannot work in someone's home office or with a small private-owned company with less than three employees.
- Students are only permitted to undertake work experience during normal working hours.
 - Hours of work should include regular full-time hours (i.e., 9.00 am - 5.00 pm, 8.00 am - 4.00 pm etc.).
 - Students are not permitted to work between the hours of 10.00 pm and 6.00 am or on weekends.
 - Work experience should be conducted within the school week.

To find an employer, students could consider the following options:

Network- Speak to family and friends who may know people within the chosen industry.

Local businesses -Approach local businesses either face to face or via phone call.

Google search businesses/industries - For example, search: Engineering Melbourne.

Send an email to different organisations requesting work experience.

Apply online for work experience placements - Large corporations may have work experience programs that have an application process. Examples include:

- Zoos Victoria
- Australian Defence Force
- Television stations
- Universities
- City of Melbourne
- Law courts
- CSIRO
- AFL clubs
- Herald Sun
- Bureau of Meteorology
- MFB

See the Appendices for examples of scripts that can be used to approach prospective employers.

Step 2: Organise Work Experience Arrangement forms

All work experience arrangements in Victoria must be made using the Work Experience Arrangement Form (see Appendices). The form can also be accessed online at:

<https://content.sdp.education.vic.gov.au/media/work-experience-arrangement-form-2551>

All sections of the form must be completed before work experience can commence. This is a legal document and covers the student under the Department of Education and Training's WorkSafe Insurance and Public Liability Insurance.

The Work Experience Arrangement Form must be completed and signed by:

- the employer
- the parent/guardian (if student is under 18 years of age)
- the student (if over 18 years of age)
- the Principal (or Assistant Principal).

Once the employer and parent/guardian have completed their sections of the form, the form must be returned to the KHS Work Experience Coordinator (see Contact details section before Appendices at end of this handbook) for approval and Principal signature. A copy of the completed Work Experience Arrangement Form will be given to all parties.

If students are required to undertake vehicle travel with an employer/supervisor during the arrangement, then the Work Experience Travel and Accommodation Form must also be signed by the employer and parent/guardian and returned to the school.

If a student is required to stay at accommodation other than his or her normal place of residence while undertaking work experience, then the Work Experience Travel and Accommodation Form must also be completed by the parent/guardian and returned to the school.

Other forms:

Travel and accommodation (away from home):

<https://content.sdp.education.vic.gov.au/media/work-experience-accommodation-form-2554>

Working with animals: [work-experience-travel-accommodation-form-2554](https://content.sdp.education.vic.gov.au/media/work-experience-travel-accommodation-form-2554)
(education.vic.gov.au)

The image shows a thumbnail of the 'Work Experience Arrangement Form'. The form is divided into several sections with headings in blue boxes. The visible sections include 'STUDENT DETAILS', 'EMPLOYER DETAILS', and 'PARENT/GUARDIAN DETAILS'. Each section contains various fields for text entry, such as names, addresses, and contact information. There are also checkboxes and areas for signatures and dates. The form is titled 'Work Experience Arrangement Form' at the top.

Payment and working conditions

The requirement in Victoria is for work experience employers to pay a minimum of \$5.00 per day. Some employers may choose to pay more but it is not a requirement.

Organisations such as schools, not-for-profit/charitable organisations and government departments are not required to pay at all.

As is the case for any employee, the student has the right to certain working conditions, including breaks, a maximum number of hours within a working day and the provision of personal protective equipment, where necessary.



Health and safety

Kew High School's priority is that students attending work experience feel safe and avoid sickness and injury. Students should not experience any bullying, harassment, or discrimination in any way or form due to their age, gender, sexual orientation, ethnicity, or religion.

It is important that students follow the occupational health and safety protocols in place at their workplace. To ensure students are aware of the health and safety guidelines, each student is to complete the safe@workGeneral module and specific Industry module during their Pathways classes. No student can commence work experience until these modules are completed and their two safe@work certificates are printed, returned to the Work Experience Coordinator, and uploaded on Compass.



Work experience checklist for students

Before returning forms to the Work Experience Coordinator, please ensure:

- the Student Details section of Work Experience Arrangement Form is completed
- the Work Placement Details section of Work Experience Arrangement Form is filled in
- the employer has completed and signed the Employer Acknowledgement section of the Work Experience Arrangement Form
- the Student Agreement section of the Work Experience Arrangement Form has been completed and signed
- the Parent/Guardian Agreement and Consent section of the Work Experience Arrangement Form has been completed and signed
- If student will be travelling with employer during the placement, the Travel and Accommodation Form is completed and signed by both the employer and parent/guardian
<https://content.sdp.education.vic.gov.au/media/work-experience-accomodation-form-2554>
- If student is staying at a different residence during their placement, the Travel and Accommodation Form is completed and signed by parent/guardian.



Final arrangements before the week of work experience

Students should contact their employers at least one week before the placement to confirm details of the placement and arrangements for the week. The school will provide all students with employer details.

Students should also ensure they finalise transport arrangements to and from the workplace before the first day.

All students will receive a Work Experience Pack one week before their placement.

This pack will contain:

- A copy of all their Work Experience Arrangement forms
- Information on their work experience placement and requirements
- Kew High School's contact details
- A copy of their safe@work certificates
- A Work Experience Placement Journal
- An Employer Evaluation Form for employers to complete

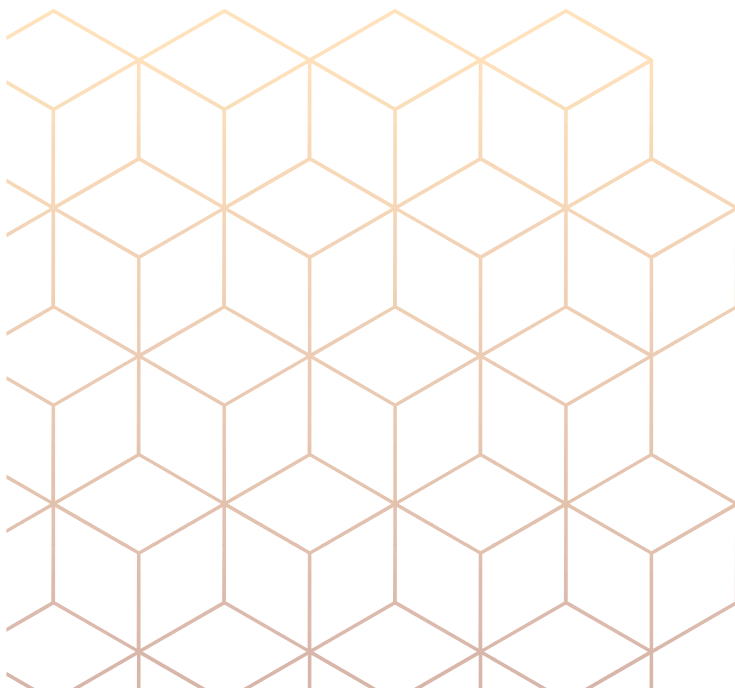
During the work experience week

During work experience, students should:

- Arrive early and dressed appropriately for their industry, or as per their employer requirements.
- Take all snacks and lunch for the first day until they determine their lunch break times and whether there is somewhere close by to purchase food.
- Represent Kew High School well by setting an exemplary standard of application, interest and involvement during their placement. Students are expected to be as positive and open to new experiences and tasks as they can be. They should get involved, ask questions if unsure and act professionally in all respects.
- Take the time to smile, interact with clients and show their best characteristics during this experience - it may be used in a resume for future job prospects.
- Always carry with them the school's contact details (see Contact details section before Appendices at end of this handbook) and their employer contact details.

All organisations expect confidentiality of their client's needs and information and we also expect that no negative social media about the student's placement be uploaded or aired publicly.

At the end of the work experience week, the student should thank each staff member they have worked with for their time and assistance. They should also indicate that they enjoyed their placement and very much appreciated the experience. A formal thank-you letter will be written in a future Pathways class lesson.



Please ensure that the following steps are taken if these situations arise:

The student is ill and cannot attend one (or more) days of their placement.

- Call the employer as soon as possible on the day.
- Call Kew High School on 9092 7500 at your earliest convenience to inform the school that the student will not be present on that day.

The student is not wanting to/is unable to continue with their placement.

- The student should not leave their workplace until they have spoken to their parent/guardian and the school's Work Experience Coordinator - Elena Tsaveas.
- The Work Experience Coordinator will contact the workplace supervisor.

The student is injured at the workplace.

- Please ensure Kew High school is notified of any injuries as soon as possible.

If there are any other issues that arise during the placement, please contact the school's Work Experience Coordinator as soon as possible.

Contact details

Kew High School Work Experience Coordinator
Elena Tsaveas Phone: 9092 7535
Email: elena.tsaveas@kew.vic.edu.au

Kew High School
General Office
Phone: 9092 7500 or 9859 8652
Email: kew@kew.vic.edu.au

Appendices (following pages)

Work experience scripts
Sample email - Requesting a work experience placement

Work experience scripts

Phone call:

These scripts may assist students in approaching employers and requesting a work experience placement.

Hello, my name is _

May I please speak with the Manager/ (specific person's name)?

Once you have the person on the phone (or in person):

Hello my name is I am a Year 10 student at Kew High School and am currently looking for a work experience placement within your industry. I was wondering whether you would be able to provide me with an opportunity to complete a week of work experience within your organisation/business?

If the employer asks for more information about work experience:

Work experience will help me learn more about your industry by observing and having some practical experience within the industry, so I can explore my career options. The dates for my work experience are Monday 22nd June until Friday 26th June.

You can also provide them with the Work Experience Guidelines for Employers (see Appendices below).

The employer may ask you to attend an interview first - ensure you write down the details and take the Work Experience Arrangement Form with you to the interview.

If the employer says YES to your request:

Thank you so much for providing me with this opportunity. I will send/bring in the appropriate paperwork for you to complete. Is there a good time for me to come and see you?

If the employer says NO to your request:

Thank you for taking the time to consider my request. It is very much appreciated.

No-one likes to have a request denied, but please do not take it personally. There may be many reasons why they can't take on a work experience student at this time. Just persevere and remain positive! Don't give up! It's not often that your first try will result in an offer of a placement. Just keep trying!



Sample email - Requesting a work experience placement

To: (Email address of employer)

Subject: Possible work experience placement Dear (Contact person or employer's name)

My name is and I am currently a Year 10 student at Kew High School.

I am enquiring about the possibility of a work experience placement with your organisation. I am very interested in the (type of industry) and would like to learn more about working in this industry.

The designated week for work experience this year is from Monday June 30th until Friday July 4th. However, this is negotiable.

Our school Work Experience Coordinator, Ms Elena Tsaveas would be happy to answer any questions you may have about the school's requirements. She can be contacted via email on elena.tsaveas@kew.vic.edu.au or by phone on 03 9092 7535.

Thank you for taking the time to consider my request for work experience. I will follow up with a phone call in the next few days to discuss this request further.

Kind regards, (Your name)
(Your email address)
(Your contact phone number)

